

International Business Strategy in the Age of Deglobalization



International Summer University^{WU} 2026 · Course Outline

Undergraduate · English · 4 ECTS

Course Instructor: Dr. Arne Floh

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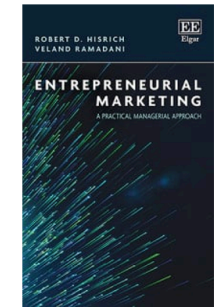
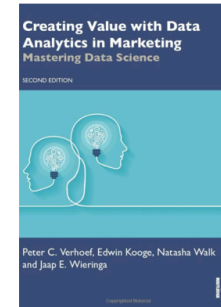
- Personal Information
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Course Instructor: Dr. Arne Floh



- Work Experience
 - International & Industry Background
 - Teaching Experience > 25 Years
- Teaching
 - Entrepreneurial Marketing
 - International Marketing
 - Marketing Research and Marketing Analytics
 - Digital Marketing & Social Media
 - Supervision (BSc, MSc, PhD)
- Research
 - Consumer Behaviour, Relationship Marketing
 - Electronic Marketing & Social Media
 - SMEs, Start-ups
 - Quantitative Methods
- Private
 - Football
 - Electronic Gadgets
 - Austrian Wine



Student introduction

Please take a moment to introduce yourself to the group:

- Your name
- Home country and home university
- Prior knowledge about international business
- Your expectations about the course
- A country where you would like to work and live
- A multinational company or brand that describes you best

Key facts

4

ECTS credits ·
undergraduate level

35

Teaching hours (45 min.
each)

8

Course days, incl. case
work & presentation

EN

Language of instruction:
English

Course title

International Business Strategy in the Age of Deglobalization, Nationalism and Geo-political tensions

Instructors

Arne Floh (arne.floh@wu.ac.at) · Can Tihanyi (can.tihanyi@wu.ac.at)

Institute

Institute for International Business, WU Vienna University of Economics and Business

Aim of the course

The international expansion of their operations is central for the survival of an increasing number of firms. In a context of **deglobalization, nationalism, and geo-political tensions**, this internationalization poses novel challenges for firms and requires them to rethink their existing strategy.

IN THIS MODULE WE ANALYZE

- The strategies used when **expanding overseas** into new country markets
- The strategies used to **operate and develop an existing network** of international operations
- How firms adapt these strategies to a context of **deglobalization, nationalism, and geo-political tensions**

Learning objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, you will:

- Have greater awareness of the deglobalization, nationalism, and geo-political tensions characterizing the current business environment
- Become aware of the various types of international strategies available to internationally operating firms
- Recognize how particular characteristics of firms and their environments affect the choice and implementation of international business strategies
- Develop the skills needed for solving the challenges firms face when considering different international business strategies in a dynamic environment
- Demonstrate improved critical thinking and problem-solving skills
- Improve communication skills necessary for effective team performance

Course schedule — Days 1 & 2

Day 1 — Introduction to IB & culture

- What is international business? Globalization of markets
- International trade, investment & the value chain
- The cultural environment & cross-cultural risk
- Dimensions of culture: values, time, language, religion
- Measuring culture: Hall, Hofstede, Schwartz & GLOBE

Day 2 — International business strategy

- Competitive advantage & generic strategies
- Porter's Five Forces & industry analysis
- Theories of trade & investment (OLI, Uppsala, RBV)
- Integration-responsiveness & the four strategies
- Building & organizing the global firm

Course schedule — Days 3 to 6

Day 3 — Market selection & entry decisions

- Selecting markets: attractiveness & the MACS matrix
- The entry-mode ladder: export → intermediate → hierarchical
- Exporting, licensing & franchising
- Collaborative ventures & foreign direct investment
- Global sourcing, supply chains & exit

Days 4–6 — Risk, nationalism & geopolitics

- Country, political & regulatory risk
- Deglobalization, nationalism & protectionism
- Geopolitical tensions & supply-chain resilience
- Managing risk: hedging, scenarios & political strategies
- Ethics, legitimacy & corporate diplomacy

Course schedule — Days 7 & 8

Day 7 — Presentation preparation

- Group work on the assigned case / theory
- Applying the frameworks from Days 1–6
- Structuring the argument & the slides
- Consultation & feedback with the instructor

Day 8 — Group presentations

- Group presentations
- Q&A and peer feedback
- Wrap-up & course reflection

Punctuality and attendance are mandatory in all sessions.

Teaching methods

This is a highly interactive course. Learning is maximized by balancing lecture with your involvement in discussions, cases, and exercises. Students are expected to be fully engaged and to participate in classroom discussions. All course documents, assignments and lecture notes are posted online.

THE COURSE IS COMPRISED OF

- Lectures
- In-class case analyses
- A team research project
- Teamwork reflection
- A final team presentation

Pre-course assignment

A concise summary of the historical development of the international operations of a company:

- Select an internationally operating company of your choice — more information is available on large, publicly listed (e.g. S&P 500) firms
- Write a short report (max. 1,000 words) on the firm's international operations: which country markets, when it entered or left them, and how (e.g. establishing a subsidiary)
- Explain why the firm expanded to those markets and chose those entry modes
- Start from the firm's website and annual reports; complement with newspaper reports — no academic journals required

Deadline Upload to Canvas by **July 15, 2026**

Course assignment — market entry into a new region

Work in **groups of 4–5 students**. Choose a multinational enterprise (MNE) that is entering — or planning to enter — a market in **one** of the following regions:

Latin America

Middle East

Far East

Africa

Central- & Eastern Europe

ANALYZE THE TARGET MARKET — SIX REQUIRED ANALYSES

- **Industry analysis** — structure, trends, Porter's Five Forces
- **Competitor analysis** — key rivals & positioning
- **Market-entry analysis** — feasible entry modes
- **SWOT analysis** — firm vs. target market
- **PESTEL analysis** — the macro-environment
- **Risk-management analysis** — detailed, with mitigation

Decide and justify a market-entry option. Bring the six analyses together into one recommended entry mode — e.g. exporting, licensing / franchising, a collaborative venture, or a wholly-owned subsidiary — and defend your choice.

Course assignment — deliverables & deadline

The presentation

- **Approx. 30 minutes** per group, plus Q&A
- Every group member presents a part
- Follow the six-analysis structure and finish with your justified recommendation
- Presented on **Day 8** of the course

Submit on Canvas

- The **slide deck** (PDF or PowerPoint)
- An **Excel sheet listing all sources** — data, references and links, mapped to each analysis
- One submission per group

Deadline Upload to Canvas by **July 16, 2026, 23:59** (midnight)

Course assignment — marking scheme

The group presentation counts for **45% of the course grade** and is marked as follows:

Criterion	What we assess	Weight
Industry & competitor analysis	Industry structure & Five Forces; key rivals and their positioning	15%
PESTEL & SWOT analysis	Macro-environment; strengths / weaknesses vs. opportunities / threats	15%
Market-entry analysis & recommendation	Entry-mode options and a clearly justified, well-argued choice	25%
Risk-management analysis	Identification, assessment and mitigation of the key risks	20%
Sources & Excel documentation	Quality, credibility and complete referencing of all data	10%
Presentation & teamwork	Structure, clarity, timing (~30 min), delivery and balanced participation	15%
Total		100%

Assessment & grading

Weighting of total grade

Assignment	Share
Pre-course assignment	25%
In-class participation	30%
Team presentation	45%

Grading scale

Range	Grade
100–90%	Excellent (1)
89–80%	Good (2)
79–70%	Satisfactory (3)
69–60%	Sufficient (4)
59–0%	Fail (5)

Workload & use of AI tools

Total workload — undergraduate, 4 ECTS

Pre-course workload	In-class activity	Outside-of-class workload
approx. 20 hours	27 hours (= 35 teaching hours)	approx. 33 hours

Use of artificial intelligence tools

- Clearly explain how you have used these tools
- Include any prompts you have used in an appendix
- Ensure that less than 5% of the text is taken directly from AI tools

Course literature

Course materials and cases are provided online. No specific textbook is required — a general International Business textbook provides useful background reading, for example:

- Charles W. Hill — *Competing in the Global Marketplace* (various editions)
- Daniels, Radebaugh & Sullivan — *International Business* (various editions)

Selected journal articles complement the class discussions, including work by Barkema et al. (1996), Dunning, Delios & Henisz (2003), Dhanaraj & Beamish (2004), Hofstede (1980) and Inkpen & Beamish (1997), among others. The full reading list is provided in the course outline.



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